

The Ranger

Rangers are scouts and natural explorers, who dabble in martial skill and nature-based magic.

Strengths:

- Healing magic.
- Highly versatile skill set and utility spells.
- Decent "frontline" combatants, with good weapons and armour.

Weaknesses:

- Lack of offensive / damage dealing magic.
- Fewer spell slots than a dedicated magic user.

You can read your character sheet for a more detailed overview.

Combat

Combat is played out in turns, with each participant (ally or enemy) going in a sequence determined by their initiative roll.

Remember, on your turn in combat you can do each of:

- Move up to your speed in distance.
- Take an action. The most common ones to take are "Make a weapon attack", or "cast a spell". But others, like hide, help an ally, or disengage (and more) are also options.
- Take a bonus action. For Rangers, your bonus action will mainly be casting your Hunter's Mark spell.

Remember that you can do *all of these*, and *in any order*. You can even break up some with the others; for example move half your speed, attack, move again, then use a bonus action.

"Typical Combat"

This ranger is geared up to primarily engage in melee combat with their swords, though they can use their longbow if no-one is nearby.

In combat, you generally want to identify the nearest enemy that you can reach, and use your bonus action to cast **Hunter's Mark** on them. You can cast this spell twice a day for free (and using one of your spell slots otherwise) and when applied to an enemy, you deal bonus damage to them whenever you hit them with a weapon attack. If you kill the enemy that was marked by your **Hunter's Mark**, you can spend your next bonus action to move it to a new target.

Your action will normally be spent taking the **"Attack with a Weapon"** action. You can either attack with your longbow, *or* attack whilst dual-wielding your shortsword and scimitar. If you dual-weld, you make 2 attacks (one with each weapon), rather than just the 1 you would make with the bow.

Your Dreadful Strikes feature also means that you do bonus damage to an enemy the first time you hit them on each of your turns in combat. This, combined with your Hunter's Mark (bonus damage each time you hit an enemy) means you generally want to be making as many attacks as possible in a turn!

Magic

As a ranger, you have access to a small range of nature-orientated spells. You have 3 spell slots that recharge after a long rest - you can use these to cast 3 spells you know. You can cast the same spell multiple times, or three completely unique spells, however you choose. We'll give an overview of what all your spells do here, so you have a quick reference.

Cantrips

Cantrips are spells that don't require you to use a spell slot to cast them. You can cast these all day, at will.

- Light: Create a small ball of light that can illuminate dark places.
- Message: Send a short, telepathic message to someone nearby (up to 120ft away). You must verbally whisper the message to send it.

Spells

These spells require you to expend a spell slot when you cast them.

- Charm Person: Attempt to charm a person, making them friendly towards you. Less effective against people who are actively hostile to you. The target *will know* you charmed them when the spell wears off!
- Cure Wounds: Touch a creature to restore 2d8+2 hit points to it.
- Detect Magic: Reveal magical auras within 30ft of yourself, for 10 minutes. This spell is a ritual; if your character has 10 minutes spare to carefully cast the spell, you don't have to use a spell slot. This spell requires your concentration.
- Find Familiar: Summon a permanent pet; such as a cat, owl, raven, mouse, badger, etc, that obeys your commands and follows you around. Primary uses are for scouting, fetching objects, and having a cute pet. The Familiar is not well-suited for combat.
- Hunter's Mark: Mark a creature to deal extra damage to it when you attack it. You can cast this spell twice per long rest *without* using a spell slot. This spell requires your concentration.
- Jump: Drastically increase the distance you or an ally can jump, for 1 minute.
- Speak with Animals: Gain the ability to speak with animals for 10 minutes. This spell is a ritual; if your character has 10 minutes spare to carefully cast the spell, you don't have to use a spell slot.